

Matthew DiGiuseppe

Associate Professor of Political Science
and International Relations

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RESEARCH International & Comparative Political Economy · International Sovereign Finance
The Political Economy of Armed Conflict (Interstate & Internal) · The Politics of AI

EMPLOYMENT

- 2022–now** **Associate Professor** (Universitair Hoofddocent)
Institute of Political Science, Universiteit Leiden
- 2018–2022** **Senior Assistant Professor with Tenure** (Universitair Docent 1)
Institute of Political Science, Universiteit Leiden
- 2012–2018** **Assistant Professor**
Department of Political Science, University of Mississippi
Stopped tenure clock for one year

EDUCATION

- 2012** **Ph.D., Political Science** · Binghamton University
- 2010** **M.A., Political Science** · Binghamton University
- 2006** **M.A., Government & Politics** · St. John's University
- 2004** **B.S., Communications** · St. John's University

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

- 2026** **NWO XS Grant** €50,000
Political Polarization and Public Support for AI Governance
- 2020–2025** **European Research Council Starting Grant** €1.5 million
Micro-foundations of Debt Crises project ([MIDEBT](#))
Seed grants for survey experiments demonstrating the constraints sovereign debt imposes on climate change initiatives:
- 2025** **Leiden University KIEM–Una Europa Grant** €10,000
With six other scholars
- 2023** **Leiden University KIEM Grant** €10,000
With four other scholars
- 2023** **Global Transformations and Governance Challenges Seed Grant** €10,000
With four other scholars

2020	Global Transformations and Governance Challenges Seed Grant With four other scholars	€9,500
2013–2018	Summer Faculty Research Grant University of Mississippi (2013, 2014, 2017 & 2018)	
	Investment Grant, Office of Research and Sponsored Programs University of Mississippi, for a survey experiment	\$2,800
2015	Southeastern (Athletic) Conference (SEC) Faculty Travel Grant Awarded by the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, University of Mississippi	
2011–2012	Dissertation Year Fellowship Awarded by the Department of Political Science, Binghamton University	
2011	International Studies Association Travel Grant	
2011	The Graduate School at Binghamton University Travel Grant	
2010	American Political Science Association Travel Grant	

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

30. **Perceived Political Bias in LLMs Reduces Persuasive Abilities** (with Joshua Robison). *PNAS Nexus*. **FORTHCOMING**
29. **Putting the Public in Public Debt** (with Jaroslaw Kantorowicz, Bastián González-Bustamante, and Alessia Aspide). *Public Choice*. **CONDITIONALLY ACCEPTED**
28. **Information, Party Politics, and Public Support for Central Bank Independence** (with Ana Carolina Garriga and Andreas Kern). *British Journal of Political Science*. **CONDITIONALLY ACCEPTED**
27. **Is the IMF a Scapegoat? A Survey Experiment in Kenya & Ghana** (with Kathleen Brown, Rod Abouharb, and Bernhard Reinsberg). *International Studies Quarterly*. **CONDITIONALLY ACCEPTED**
26. **Scaling Open-ended Survey Responses Using LLM-Paired Comparisons** (with Michael E. Flynn). 2026. *Public Opinion Quarterly* 90(1).
25. **The Mass Politics of Public Debt, Immigration, and Austerity** (with Alessia Aspide). 2025. *Journal of European Public Policy*, online first.
24. **Information, Uncertainty, and Public Support for Brinkmanship during the 2023 Debt Limit Negotiations** (with Patrick Shea). 2025. *British Journal of Political Science* 55: e14.
23. **How to Finance Green Investments? The Role of Public Debt** (with Jaroslaw Kantorowicz, Marion Collewet, and Hendrik Vrijburg). 2024. *Energy Policy* 184: 113899.
22. **Farming Then Fighting: Agricultural Idle Time and Armed Conflict** (with Roos van der Haer and Babak Rezaee). 2024. *Political Science Research and Methods* 12(4): 897–906.
21. **Threats and the Public Constraint on Military Spending** (with Alessia Aspide and Jordan M. Becker). 2024. *British Journal of Political Science* 54(3): 649–666.
20. **Ethnic Politics and Sovereign Credit Risk** (with Kathleen Brown and Patrick Shea). 2024. *Review of International Political Economy* 31(2): 589–621.
19. **Age and Support for Public Debt Reduction** (with Alessia Aspide, Kathleen Brown, and Alexander Slaski). 2023. *European Journal of Political Research* 62(4): 1191–1211.

18. **Culture and European Attitudes on Public Debt** (with Alessia Aspide, Kathleen Brown, and Alexander Slaski). 2023. *New Political Economy* 28(4): 509–525.
17. **The Wedding Bells of War: The Influence of Armed Conflict on Child Marriages in West Africa** (with Roos van der Haer). 2023. *Journal of Peace Research* 60(3): 474–488.
16. **Do Consumers Follow the Flag? Perceptions of Hostility and Consumer Preferences** (with Colin M. Barry). 2022. *International Interactions* 48(6): 1200–1215.
15. **U.S. Patronage, State Capacity, and Civil Conflict** (with Patrick Shea). 2022. *Journal of Politics* 84(2): 767–782.
14. **Alliances, Signals of Support, and Military Effort** (with Patrick Shea). 2021. *European Journal of International Relations* 27(4): 1067–1089.
13. **The Devil’s Haircut: Investor–State Disputes over Debt Restructuring** (with Patrick Shea). 2019. *Journal of Conflict Resolution* 63(8): 1889–1922.
12. **Economics, Security, and Individual-Level Preferences for Trade Agreements** (with Katja Kleinberg). 2019. *International Interactions* 45(2): 289–315.
11. **Transparency, Risk, and FDI** (with Colin M. Barry). 2019. *Political Research Quarterly* 72(1): 132–146.
10. **International Development NGOs and Bureaucratic Capacity: Facilitator or Destroyer?** (with Susanna Campbell and Amanda Murdie). 2019. *Political Research Quarterly* 72(1): 3–18.
9. **Sovereign Credit and Political Survival in Democracies** (with Patrick Shea). 2018. *Business and Politics* 20(3): 360–389.
8. **Arms versus Democratic Allies** (with Paul Poast). 2018. *British Journal of Political Science* 48(4): 981–1003.
7. **The Physical Consequences of Fiscal Flexibility: Sovereign Credit and Physical Integrity Rights** (with K. Chad Clay). 2017. *British Journal of Political Science* 47(4): 783–807.
6. **Borrowed Time: Sovereign Finance, Regime Type, and Leader Survival** (with Patrick Shea). 2016. *Economics & Politics* 28(3): 342–367.
5. **Guns, Butter, and Debt: Sovereign Creditworthiness and Military Expenditure**. 2015. *Journal of Peace Research* 52(5): 680–693.
4. **Sovereign Credit and the Fate of Leaders: Reassessing the “Democratic Advantage”** (with Patrick Shea). 2015. *International Studies Quarterly* 59(3): 557–570.
3. **The Fiscal Autonomy of Deciders: Creditworthiness and Conflict Initiation**. 2015. *Foreign Policy Analysis* 11(3): 317–338.
2. **Tightening the Belt: Sovereign Debt and Alliance Formation** (with Michael A. Allen). 2013. *International Studies Quarterly* 57(4): 647–659.
1. **Good for the Money? International Finance, State Capacity and Internal Armed Conflict** (with Colin M. Barry and Richard W. Frank). 2012. *Journal of Peace Research* 49(3): 391–405.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

REVISE & RESUBMIT

Bottom-Up Preferences for Public Debt Reduction and Repayment (with Alessandro Del Ponte)

AI on the Battlefield? Revisiting Public Support for LAWs (with Katrin Paula and Tobias Rommel)

UNDER REVIEW

Ad Machina: Partisanship and Support for Delegating Government Decisions to Autonomous Algorithms (with Katrin Paula and Tobias Rommel)

The Partisan Bias in Inflation Expectations (with Ana Carolina Garriga and Andreas Kern)

External Threats and Support for International Cooperation (with Jordan Becker, Haemin Jee, and Tongfi Kim)

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

- Sep 2026 **Agentic AI in Social Science Research: From Annotators to Autonomous Pipelines.** School of Social Sciences, University of Manchester.
- May 2026 **Agentic AI in Social Science Research: From Annotators to Autonomous Pipelines.** University of Glasgow.
- Jul 2023 **Bottom-Up Sovereign Debt Preferences.** Politics of Finance Conference, Technical University of Munich.
- Feb 2022 **Military Expenditure, External Threats and Fiscal Consolidation: A Survey Experiment in Italy** (with Alessia Aspidi and Jordan M. Becker). NATO Strategic Concept Conference, U.S. Military Academy, West Point, NY.
- 2020 **Banking on Conflict: Funding Military Might with Unwitting Lenders.** Speaker Series of the Department of Government, University of Essex.
- 2016 **Divided Government, Sovereign Finance, and Government Survival in Democracies** (with Patrick Shea). The Political Economy of Risk Conference, University of Houston.
- 2015 **Divided Government, Sovereign Finance, and Government Survival in Democracies** (with Patrick Shea). Politics of Government Revenue Conference, organized by Kevin Morrison and Helen Milner, Princeton University.
- 2015 **The Politics of Debt Restructuring: Institutions, Preferences, and Creditor Losses** (with Patrick Shea). University of Memphis.

VALORIZATION & PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

- 2022 “Russia faces its first default since 1918 – here’s how it could complicate Putin’s ability to wage war in Ukraine.” Published in *The Conversation*.
- 2022 Invited to present at the NATO Strategic Concept Conference at the United States Military Academy (West Point, NY).
- 2018 Guest on the Niskanen Center’s *Science of Politics* podcast, Episode 15: “[How Debt Finance Leads to War and Defense Spending](#).”

UNPUBLISHED PAPERS & CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- 2017 **Power Parity & Trade** (with Nathan A. Andrew). Southern Political Science Association, New Orleans, LA, 2017.

2015–2017	Foreign Aid and Private Goods: Finding Evidence of Capture with Trade Data. Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL, 2015; International Studies Association, Atlanta, GA, 2016; Southern Political Science Association, New Orleans, LA, 2017.
2016	Fiscal Space and Coercive Diplomacy. American Political Science Association, Philadelphia, PA, 2016.
2014–2016	Fiscal Constraints and the Pursuit of Peace. International Studies Association, Toronto, Canada, 2014, and Atlanta, GA, 2016.
2014	“Propping up” Leaders with US Foreign Aid (with Michael E. Flynn). Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL, 2014.
2014	Commodity Shocks, Shock Absorbers and Civil Conflict (with Richard W. Frank). American Political Science Association, Washington, D.C., 2014.
2014	Economic Competition and Labor Rights (with K. Chad Clay and Colin M. Barry). International Studies Association, Toronto, Canada, 2014, and International Political Economy Society, Washington, D.C., 2014.
2014	Out of the Frying Pan: INGOs, Economic Crises and Human Security (with Amanda Murdie). Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL, 2014.
2012–2013	State Opposition: Separation, Simultaneity, and Sequential Causation in Terrorism and Civil Conflict (with Michael A. Allen and Richard W. Frank). Midwest Political Science Association, 2013; scheduled for the American Political Science Association, 2012.
2011	Bullets and Bonds: International Sovereign Finance and Rivalry Behavior. International Studies Association, Montreal, QC, Canada, 2011, and Peace Science Society, Los Angeles, CA, 2011.
2009	A Good Friend Isn’t Hard to Buy: Economic Interdependence and Alliance Reliability. American Political Science Association, Toronto, Ontario, Canada, 2009.

SERVICE TO THE DISCIPLINE

2022–2026	Associate Editor, <i>International Studies Review</i> Editorial Board Member, <i>International Studies Review</i> Editorial Board Member, <i>International Interactions</i> Reviewer for over 20 journals
2022, 2023	Jury Member, Els Witte PhD Prize

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

Leiden	Director of Postgraduate Studies	Aug 2023 – Dec 2025
	Institute Board Member	Aug 2023 – Dec 2025
	Direct supervision of 6 instructors and support staff	
	MSc Opleidingscommissie, Chair	Sep 2021 – 2023
	MSc Opleidingscommissie, Member (Acting Chair, July–October 2020)	2019 – present
	Research Committee	2021 – 2023
	PhD Taskforce Member	2021 – 2022

PhD supervision: graduated Spielberger, Aspide, Brown; currently supervising Mirelmi, Akkerman, Slupski

Direct supervision of 1 postdoc

Search Committee Chair: 3 UD's in International Relations 2025

Search Committee Chair: 1 UD in Development Politics 2021

Search Committee Chair: 2 PhDs in IPE 2020

Search Committee Chair: 1 Postdoc in IPE 2020

Search Committee Member: 5 UD's 2019

Search Committee Member: 1 UD in European Politics 2019

Organizer, Politics and Policy Pre-Analysis Plan Workshop ongoing

Mississippi Graduate Admissions Committee

PhD co-supervision (2 students)

Search Committee Member (Assistant Professor)

TEACHING

2022 Basis Kwalificatie Onderwijs (BKO), the Dutch University Teaching Qualification

Leiden Economics for Political Science · Introduction to International Political Economy · International Political Economy · Foreign Policy in the Trump Era (Bachelor Project & Seminar)

Mississippi Introduction to International Relations · Politics of the World Economy · International Conflict · Ethnic Conflict and International Terrorism · Global Political Economy (Graduate Seminar) · Graduate Pro-Seminar in International Relations · Political Economy of Conflict (Honors Seminar) · War in World Politics · Foreign Policy in the Trump Era (Honors Seminar)

Binghamton Political Economy of Armed Conflict · Domestic Forces in International Relations · Political Economy of International Economic Crises · Introduction to World Politics · International Political Economy

SKILLS

Languages English (native speaker) · Dutch (B1)

Software R · Stata · SPSS · $\text{\LaTeX}$